GARRETT HAPTONSTALL

Linux Systems Administrator | Full-Stack Developer | Infrastructure Engineer

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Live: fear.is-cool.dev · efear.shop · fear.dedyn.io

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Linux systems administrator and full-stack developer with 15 years of experience designing, securing, and automating infrastructure and the applications that run on it. Track record spans enterprise network builds (500+ devices on a fiber backbone), AWS migrations with measurable cost reductions, and team leadership on products serving 10,000+ users. Currently designing, building, and self-hosting a production e-commerce platform end to end: Express/MongoDB API, Next.js storefront, payment processing, nginx/TLS, and PM2 process management.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Systems & Networking: Linux (Debian, Red Hat), Windows Server, Nginx, Apache, Cisco IOS, VLANs, SonicWall, VoIP/PBX, VMware/VirtualBox, Vagrant

Cloud & DevOps: AWS (EC2, RDS, S3, Auto Scaling, Load Balancing), Google Cloud, Docker, Ansible, PM2, Git, Subversion, Nagios, Wireshark

Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, Node.js, SQL, PHP, Java, HTML5/CSS3

Frameworks & Libraries: Next.js, React, Redux Toolkit, RTK Query, Express.js, AngularJS, jQuery, Tailwind CSS, Mongoose

Databases: MongoDB, MySQL, PostgreSQL, SQL Server

Payments & Real-Time: Stripe (Elements), PayPal SDK, WebRTC

AI-Assisted Development: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Google AI

FEATURED PROJECTS

eFear Storefront | efear.shop Live

Next.js 15 (App Router), TypeScript, RTK Query, Tailwind CSS, Stripe, PayPal

- Migrated a comics, e-book, and collectibles storefront from Create React App to Next.js 15 App Router with strict TypeScript, adding server-side rendering and ISR so product and shop pages are indexable by search engines.
- Built the full customer experience: product catalog with filtering and pagination, cart, account area, authentication, blog, and a 5-step checkout with Stripe Elements and PayPal.
- Preserved the existing Express backend by proxying API traffic through Next.js rewrites; managed state with Redux Toolkit and RTK Query.
- Enforced architecture conventions (feature-based structure, ESLint, Prettier, Husky/lint-staged) and deployed with PM2 behind an nginx reverse proxy with TLS.

FEAR-Admin | fear.dedyn.io Live (e-commerce backend)

Node.js, Express, MongoDB/Mongoose, nginx, PM2

- Designed and built a REST API and CMS on the MERN stack, built on a custom in-house Express framework, serving as the e-commerce backend for the storefront.
- Implemented authentication and accounts, product catalog, cart, checkout, and orders, with Stripe and PayPal payment-intent routes.
- Self-hosted across multiple domains with nginx reverse proxies and TLS; diagnosed and resolved certificate and server_name routing issues.

Portfolio & Services Site | fear.is-cool.dev Live

FEAR GUI framework, jQuery, GSAP, esbuild, Node.js

- Built an interactive portfolio on an in-house UI framework with a custom esbuild pipeline, animated intro and backgrounds, and modal project views, served by the FEAR Node backend.
- Presents selected work, services, and publications, including e-books published on Amazon.

V-Chat | WebRTC Video Platform In development

- Adding a WebRTC signaling service to the FEAR Node/Express backend, with a React/TypeScript client themed for live selling and virtual events.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent IT Consultant & Developer May 2016 – Present
Self-Employed

- Deliver full-stack web development, Android development, and Linux systems administration for a diverse client base.
- Perform security assessments, penetration testing, stress testing, and load-balancing optimization.
- Architect, host, and operate personal platforms including the FEAR e-commerce stack and the GUI (Guerrilla UI) framework.
- **Key achievement:** Delivered 20+ projects, from e-commerce platforms to enterprise system migrations.

Lead Mobile Developer June 2015 – March 2016
SHINDiiG LLC (Suaray) | Henderson, NV

- Led mobile development for the Suaray event-finder and social platform serving 10,000+ active users.
- Built cross-platform apps in AngularJS, then migrated the Android app to native Java with Material Design.
- Enhanced RESTful API functionality in PHP, optimized database performance, and managed the network, database, and server infrastructure behind the platform and its automated email systems.
- **Key achievement:** Reduced app load times by 40% through the native Java rewrite and database optimization.

Full-Stack Developer & Systems Administrator April 2014 – Present
Moshyn Inc. | Las Vegas, NV

- Developed websites, iPhone apps, and Android apps for startup clients, and managed client server infrastructure and ongoing support.
- Architected and deployed AWS infrastructure for major clients, including Worldpokertour.com.
- Built and launched products including Pijun (bug tracking) and LoopSale (community marketplace).
- **Key achievement:** Migrated Worldpokertour.com to AWS with 99.9% uptime and a 50% cost reduction.

Lead Developer June 2013 – April 2014
SearchCore LLC (Manufacturedhomes.com) | Lake Forest, CA

- Led a team of 5 building a geo-targeted manufactured-home finder on Node.js, Nginx, and AWS (S3, EC2).
- Created management tools for users, dealers, employees, and manufacturers, plus mortgage calculators, document management, and calendaring.
- **Key achievement:** Platform serves major manufacturers including Kabco Builders and Magnolia Homes, with 25% year-over-year growth.

Senior Programmer & Network Administrator January 2012 – May 2013
Business Development Institute LLC

- Managed 15+ Linux servers, a Windows 2008 domain, VM servers, and VoIP/PBX systems; supported 50+ end users and led a team of 2.
- Built company websites on multiple PHP frameworks (Zend, Kohana, WordPress, Drupal, CakePHP) and introduced version control.
- **Key achievement:** Reduced server downtime by 80% through proactive monitoring and redundancy.

Linux Systems Administrator January 2011 – September 2011
Murder Inc. / Eagle Group Holdings LLC | Las Vegas, NV

- Led 3 IT technicians supporting 30+ users during construction of the Las Vegas Mob Experience.
- Designed and implemented the complete network from scratch, configuring Cisco IOS with multiple VLANs for load balancing.
- Installed and connected 500+ devices to a centralized system over a 4GB fiber-optic backbone.
- **Key achievement:** Delivered the network on time and under budget for a high-profile Las Vegas attraction.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- **AWS infrastructure:** cloud solutions for enterprise clients with documented cost savings of 30–50%.
- **Security:** security assessments and penetration testing for Fortune 500 companies.
- **Performance:** 30–40% application performance gains through code optimization and infrastructure tuning.
- **Leadership:** managed development teams of 2–5 engineers across concurrent projects.

EDUCATION

IT University Online | CCNA coursework (Cisco Certified Network Associate)
Stephen F. Austin State University | General Business 2005 – 2006
Grapevine High School | Diploma 2001 – 2005